

Comprehensive Leave, Attendance, and Time-Off Policy

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Version: 5.5

Effective Date: February 1, 2024

Policy Owner: Total Rewards & Employee Wellness

Classification: Internal / Public (Employees)

1. Purpose and Objective

The Company promotes a healthy work-life balance and physical well-being. This policy outlines the entitlements, accrual mechanisms, request procedures, and general guidelines for all categories of paid and unpaid leave available to employees.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all regular full-time and part-time employees. Temporary workers, contractors, and consultants are governed by their respective vendor agreements and are not eligible for paid time off under this document unless explicitly mandated by local statutory law.

3. Core Leave Categories and Accruals

3.1 Privilege Leave (Annual Leave)

- Entitlement:** 24 working days per calendar year.
- Accrual:** Leave is accrued uniformly at a rate of 2.0 days per month of active service.
- Carry-Forward:** Employees may carry forward a maximum of 12 unused Privilege Leave days to the next calendar year.
- Encashment:** Unused Privilege Leave beyond the 12-day carry-forward limit will automatically lapse on December 31. Encashment is only permitted during full and final settlement upon termination or resignation, calculated on the base salary component.

3.2 Sick and Medical Leave

- **Entitlement:** 12 working days per calendar year, credited upfront on January 1st (prorated for mid-year joiners).
- **Documentation Threshold:** Any sick leave extending beyond 3 consecutive working days requires a registered medical practitioner's certificate.
- **Non-Carry-Forward:** Sick leave balances reset to zero at the end of the calendar year and cannot be encashed under any circumstances.

3.3 Casual Leave (Personal Emergencies)

- **Entitlement:** 6 working days per calendar year.
- **Usage:** Designed for sudden personal emergencies (e.g., household repairs, emergency child care). Casual leave cannot be combined with Privilege Leave. A maximum of 2 consecutive days can be taken at one time.

4. Family and Parental Leave

4.1 Maternity Leave

- **Eligibility:** Female employees who have completed at least 80 days of continuous service.
- **Entitlement:** 26 continuous weeks of fully paid leave. Up to 8 weeks can be taken pre-delivery.
- **Miscarriage/Medical Termination:** 6 weeks of fully paid leave from the date of the event, subject to medical documentation.

4.2 Paternity Leave

- **Eligibility:** Male employees, effective immediately upon joining.
- **Entitlement:** 4 weeks (20 working days) of fully paid leave.
- **Condition:** Must be fully utilized within 6 months of the child's birth date. Can be taken in a maximum of two separate blocks.

4.3 Adoption & Surrogacy Leave

- **Primary Caregiver:** Entitled to 16 weeks of paid leave for adopting a child under the age of 3.
- **Secondary Caregiver:** Entitled to 4 weeks of paid leave.

5. Specialized Leave Types

5.1 Bereavement and Compassionate Leave

- Employees are granted 5 paid working days in the event of the death of an immediate family member (defined strictly as a spouse, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or parent-in-law).
- HR may grant up to 2 additional paid travel days if the employee must travel internationally for funeral arrangements.

5.2 Sabbatical Leave (Unpaid)

- **Eligibility:** Employees who have completed 5 continuous years of exceptional service.
- **Entitlement:** Up to 6 months of unpaid leave for higher education, extensive travel, or personal rejuvenation.
- **Conditions:** The employee's role is not guaranteed upon return, though the Company will make reasonable efforts to place them in a comparable position. Healthcare benefits will be suspended during the sabbatical unless the employee pays the full premium.

6. Request and Approval Workflows

1. **Advance Notice:** All planned Privilege Leave must be requested via the HRMS Portal at least 14 days in advance.
2. **Managerial Discretion:** Line managers reserve the right to decline or reschedule leave requests based on critical business deliverables or overlapping team absences.
3. **Job Abandonment:** Any employee absent from work for 5 consecutive business days without notifying their manager or HR will be subject to the Job Abandonment protocol, leading to presumed voluntary resignation.

7. Point of Contact

- **System/Portal Issues:** it-helpdesk@company.com
- **Leave Balance Disputes:** payroll-services@company.com
- **Policy Clarifications:** hr-benefits@company.com

8. Amendment History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
4.0	Jan 10, 2021	HR Benefits Team	Overhaul of the parental leave structure.
5.1	Aug 22, 2022	Rachel Zane	Increased Paternity Leave from 2 weeks to 4 weeks.

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
5.3	May 15, 2023	David Kim	Added definitions for secondary caregivers in Adoption.
5.5	Jan 12, 2024	Total Rewards Team	Increased Privilege Leave accrual to 24 days; modified Job Abandonment from 7 days to 5 days.

9. Authorizations and Signatures

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